and accountants on the rolls of the two NGOs serving the public. One amazing project, which was in the pipeline since 1999 and has finally seen the light of day, relates to the making and finally the screening of a non-fiction feature film on my life, entitled *Yes, Madam Sir*. It has been produced by Australian film maker Megan Doneman. This film is being screened in film festivals around the world. Its commentator is an Academy Award winner, Helen Mirren. I have personally been present during some screenings in Toronto, Dubai and Adelaide, to address the Q&A sessions at the end of each show. Every time it has been screened, it has received a standing ovation. The documentary has made a clean sweep of the award categories: It won the Best Documentary Award (with a cash prize of $100,000, the biggest amount for a documentary for any film festival in the US) and the Social Justice Award (with a cash prize of $2500) at the 2009 Santa Barbara International Film Festival. *Yes, Madam Sir* got a unanimous vote from the jury. (For more on the documentary, please search for *Yes, Madam Sir* on the Internet.)

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Life, post-retirement, remains enriched with creative and productive work. Earlier I used to serve to earn now I am earning to serve. The award moneys, book royalties, speaker fees and newspaper, radio and television honorariums are all dedicated to my not-for-profit foundations.

As I set myself free, I was offered what turned out to be a life-altering proposal from the Star TV Channel and Siddhartha Basu, India's leading creative television producer, for hosting a television show called *Aap Ki Kachehri* (Your Court). This is a show in which I am a judge between two disputing parties who volunteer to come on television and plead their case and hope to get a resolution in their favour. The show has no retakes or written scripts. It is the first of its kind on Indian TV. As per the feedback it is being watched worldwide. For me, this is an extension of my lifelong work: listening, negotiating, counselling, persuading, deciding, adjudicating, spreading legal awareness and announcing verdicts!

One-Woman Show

'The show is all about real people, real life disputes, real emotions and real happenings. There are no fake emotions, no fake controversies. The show delivers instant justice. There are no actors, no rehearsals, and no retakes. It's about the underbelly of life which is afraid of exposure,' says India's first female DGP Kiran Bedi.

This ex-IPS officer is no stranger to television. Her first venture *Galti Kiski* on Doordarshan was a hit with the masses. Kiran's USP is her ability to empathise with people's [problems] and help them in every way possible.

What actually encouraged her to do the show? 'I want to help people more effectively. The visual media is the most powerful medium of impact for change, and if one wants to live and drive change, then this is one of the most facilitating routes,' says Bedi. The concept was elucidated by Siddhartha Basu, producer, Synergy Adlabs. 'He was my mentor and always behaved like family. The whole team which works under him is full of professional zeal and commitment,' she reveals.

Kiran Bedi fulfills all the requirements to make a perfect host on this show. Her 35 years of practical police experience in the police force, 20 years of experience with NGOs, education in law and a doctorate [on the topic of] domestic violence make her a strong individual with the capacity to face and handle different humans with different mental levels.